

QuoteGuard — SaaS Deal Desk & Pricing Governance Simulator

Project Overview

1. What This Project Is

QuoteGuard is a standalone portfolio project simulating the Pricing Analyst / Deal Desk function at a modular, enterprise SaaS company — modeled on the commercial realities of Varonis (unified data security platform, per-user licensing, layered add-ons and standalone modules, enterprise/regulated customer base).

It covers the full commercial lifecycle — new-business quoting, renewals, deployment migrations, multi-currency pricing, competitive benchmarking, and approval governance — built as a single 9-sheet Excel workbook (QuoteGuard_Model.xlsx).

It is intentionally not an extension of PriceBridge (a separate, earlier EY-focused FP&A/pricing-strategy project). QuoteGuard is scoped around the pricing/deal-desk function specifically — quoting, discount governance, and reporting-readiness — not broader pricing strategy work.

2. The Corrected Commercial Model

The model went through several rounds of correction as research surfaced how the real platform is actually licensed and packaged (documented in full in the Decision Log referenced throughout the build). The final structure:

Recurring (ARR) components — 12 licensable capabilities:

- Core Platform (Essentials or Advanced tier), priced by size band, driven by licensed user count (not raw headcount, which is only a loose proxy) and deployment type
- 4 Add-Ons (priced as % uplift on Core Platform, since they extend rather than replace it): MDDR, Identity Resolution, Identity Posture, AI Security (Atlas)
- 7 standalone Additional Modules (flat price by band): Database Activity Monitoring, Data-Centric UEBA, DLP, ITDR, Interceptor Email Security, Interceptor Browser Security, Email Data Protection
- Concierge and Athena AI — always shown as Included, \$0, never priceable (genuine competitive differentiators, not revenue lines)
- Deliberately excluded: Varonis "Solutions" pages (Insider Risk Management, Ransomware Prevention, Compliance Management, etc.) and industry/vertical pages — these are use-case bundles built from the modules already priced, not separate billable SKUs

One-time components:

- Implementation Fee, T-shirt sized (S/M/L/XL mapped to size bands), priced per component — every selected module (Core Platform + each Add-On + each Additional Module) carries its own line, always labeled "Indicative — Deal Desk/Solutions team to confirm."
- Fully itemized on both Deal_Overview and Renewal_Overview, not shown only as a lump sum.

Multi-currency:

- USD / GBP / EUR selectable on both Overview sheets
- Default FX rates live in Lookup_Tables; each calculation sheet has its own manual override cell so the pricing team can adjust rates per business guidance without touching the reference table

Deal-level metrics:

- PUPY / PUPM (Per User Per Year/Month) — the Varonis-equivalent of Zellis' PEPM

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- TCV, Effective Discount %, Implementation-as-%-of-Year-1-ACV
 - A live Discount % "what-if" cell on Deal_Overview (a quick simulator, distinct from the formal approval workflow)

Competitive benchmarking:

- Kept in a fully isolated Competitive_Benchmark sheet

Competitor pricing modeled as a positioning multiplier against Varonis' own List ACV for the current deal, not a fixed dollar quote — this keeps the comparison valid as module selection changes, rather than going stale the moment a deal's scope shifts

Renewals and migration:

- Separate Renewal_Input / Renewal_Calculation / Renewal_Overview sheets, referencing the same Lookup_Tables (no duplicated pricing data)
- Standard renewal: prior contract value × uplift %, plus/minus any module add/remove requests
- Two independent escalation flags, which can fire simultaneously: Renewal Shrinkage (ACV declining vs. prior term) and Deployment Migration (on-prem↔cloud change), each triggering review regardless of the other
- Newly-added modules at renewal correctly trigger their own implementation fee, itemized the same way as new business

Approval governance:

- A 3-stage workflow (Pricing Analyst → Manager Approved → Final Quote Sent) lives in the hidden, password-protected calculation sheets
- Each Overview sheet shows a read-only, color-coded (green/red) mirror of the same statuses — account managers see the state, only the pricing team can change it

Account Manager attribution:

- Free-text AM Name and Team/Market Segment fields on both Deal_Input and Renewal_Input (not a locked dropdown roster), so any AM can use the tool without IT setup

3. Workbook Structure — 9 Sheets

Sheet	Visibility	Purpose
Deal_Input	Visible	New-business deal parameters (AM-facing)
Deal_Overview	Visible	New-business quote summary — full line-item breakdown, currency, discount simulator, approval status
Renewal_Input	Visible	Existing-customer renewal parameters (AM-facing)
Renewal_Overview	Visible	Renewal quote summary — same structure as Deal_Overview, plus growth/shrinkage and migration flags
Competitive_Benchmark	Visible	Isolated competitor research, multiplier-based delta
Deal_Log	Visible	~18 synthetic historical deals, formula-driven off the same pricing engine — structured as a flat, row-per-deal table so it's ready to feed a reporting tool later without restructuring
Lookup_Tables	Hidden + password-protected	Single source of truth for all pricing, FX, industry, renewal, and AM-team reference data
Pricing_Calculation	Hidden + password-protected	New-business pricing engine, FX control, approval workflow
Renewal_Calculation	Hidden + password-protected	Renewal pricing engine, migration logic, FX control, approval workflow

Password: QuoteGuard2026 (basic Excel sheet/workbook protection — sufficient to keep the tool "clean" for account managers, not intended as enterprise-grade security).

4. Deliverables

1. Excel workbook (QuoteGuard_Model.xlsx) — all 9 sheets described above
2. Documentation set — this Overview, the Step-by-Step Build Guide, and the README
3. Screenshots — Deal_Overview, Renewal_Overview, and the approval workflow in action

5. What Success Looks Like

A reviewer can open the workbook, quote a new enterprise deal across 12 modules with a live discount and currency conversion, quote a renewal with a deployment migration and watch both escalation flags fire independently, glance at a scope-aware competitive delta, and trust that every number traces back to exactly one source of truth — without the tool ever mixing up what's included, what's one-time, what's negotiable, or what's stale.

6. Roadmap

Deal_Log was deliberately built as a reporting-ready table — formula-driven off the same Lookup_Tables pricing engine as the rest of the workbook, one row per deal — so it can feed a BI tool (Power BI, or Excel PivotTables/Charts) without any restructuring. That visualization layer isn't built yet; the intended design is documented in the Step-by-Step Guide for whenever there's reason to pick it back up.